

IEEE Code of Ethics

The IEEE Code of Ethics, updated in 2020, is a concise list of commitments that all IEEE members agree to follow. The Code emphasizes integrity, responsible behavior, and respect for others.

Key Principles Include:

- Uphold the highest standards of integrity and ethical conduct.
- Avoid real or perceived conflicts of interest.
- Be honest and realistic in stating claims or estimates based on available data.
- Reject bribery in all forms.
- Improve the understanding of technology and its appropriate application.
- Maintain and improve technical competence and support others in doing so.
- Treat all persons fairly and with respect, avoiding discrimination.
- Avoid injuring others, their property, reputation, or employment through false or malicious action.
- Support colleagues and cooperate in professional development.
- Disclose promptly factors that might endanger the public or the environment.

ACM Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct

The ACM Code, last updated in 2018, outlines ethical principles to guide computing professionals. It is divided into four main sections:

1. General Ethical Principles

These principles are broad and apply to all computing professionals:

- **Contribute to society and human well-being:** Technology should enhance human life and dignity.
- **Avoid harm:** Professionals must avoid actions that harm others, whether through negligence or intent.
- **Be honest and trustworthy:** Truthfulness is critical in all aspects of work, including communication and software development.
- **Respect privacy:** Protect personal and confidential information.
- **Honor confidentiality:** Obligations to clients, employers, and others must be upheld.

2. Professional Responsibilities

These address how professionals should behave in their specific roles:

- **Strive for high quality:** Products and services should be technically sound and reliable.

- **Maintain competence:** Continue learning and improving skills throughout one's career.
- **Know and respect existing laws:** Professionals must obey relevant laws and regulations.
- **Accept and provide professional review:** Constructive feedback helps maintain quality and accountability.

3. Professional Leadership Principles

These apply to those in positions of influence:

- **Ensure public good is the central concern:** Leaders must consider the impact of technology on society.
- **Foster ethical behavior:** Encourage ethical decision-making among teams and organizations.

4. Compliance with the Code

- Professionals are expected to uphold, promote, and support the Code.
- Violations may result in disciplinary action from ACM.